

A second life for waste

Waste to Wealth

Sorted at home, waste has value: it can be sold or turned into compost. Mixed together, it is just rubbish.

Small actions. Cleaner communities.
A greener Pakistan.

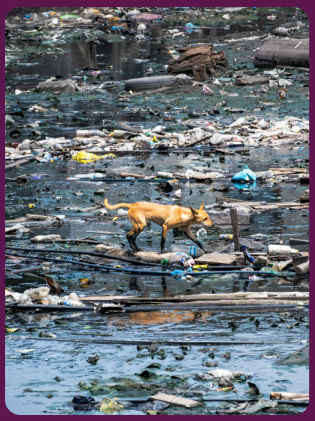
VSO Volunteers spark others

WHY IT MATTERS

Where does it go?

The same waste can end up two ways. Which way is decided at home.

IF IT IS MIXED AND DUMPED



Blocked drains.
Plastic chokes the water.



Open dumps.
Rotting waste adds to climate change.



Burning.
Smoke we all breathe.

IF IT IS KEPT APART

It becomes something valuable.

Food scraps
Compost for plants and fields

Paper and card
Sold, then made into new paper

Metal and glass
Sold, melted and made again

Plastic
Sold, shredded and remade

Money and compost, instead of rubbish.

1

STEP 1 OF 3

Refuse and rethink.

The cheapest waste is the waste you never bring home.

BEFORE YOU TAKE A PLASTIC ITEM, CIRCLE ONE

✓ ✗	1	Do I need it?
✓ ✗	2	Does it have to come in this packaging?
✓ ✗	3	Do I need a new bag or container for it?
✓ ✗	4	Can I use this item many times?
✓ ✗	5	If I throw it away, can it be recycled locally?

Any cross? Leave it on the shelf.

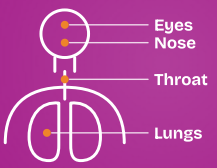
Say no to single-use plastic

- Shopping bags
- Straws
- Cups and plates
- Bottles
- Food wrappers
- Spoons and forks

Don't burn your rubbish.

The smoke irritates the eyes, nose and throat. Tiny particles go deep into the lungs.

Instead: sort it, sell it, compost it.



2

STEP 2 OF 3

Sort and use.

Sorting keeps waste worth something. Mixed, it is worth nothing.

Three colours: green, blue, red.

No coloured bins? Three bags or boxes will do. Use the same colours at home and on your street.



GREEN

Organic

Peels, food scraps, leaves, garden waste.

MAKE COMPOST

Mix with dry leaves or torn paper. Keep it damp, turn it now and then, and wait.

BLUE

Recyclable

Paper, cardboard, cans, glass, plastic bottles and tubs.

SELL IT

Keep it clean and dry. Sell it to a scrap dealer or take it to a collection point.

RED

Special

Batteries, electronics, chemicals, medicines, sharp things, sanitary waste.

KEEP IT APART

In its own bag, wrapped. Ask your local authority where to hand it in.



Respect the people who handle our waste

Wrap broken glass and needles. Sort properly. Treat waste workers with dignity.

3

STEP 3 OF 3

Track and reduce.

The 7-day challenge. Weigh what leaves your home for a week, then work out what it is worth.

My week of waste

WEEK OF _____

WASTE	KG	PRICE PER KG	WORTH (RS)
Food waste		*compost it*	–
Plastic			
Paper and card			
Glass			
Metal			
Special waste		*keep apart*	–
Everything else		–	–
My week of recyclables is worth			

Worth = kg × price, added up for plastic, paper, glass and metal. Prices change, so write yours in pencil.



Ask the scrap dealer

1. What do you buy, and what not?
2. What is today's price per kg?
3. Will you collect from our street?

What surprised us?

What will we cut next week?

FROM ONE HOME TO ONE STREET

The 8-week action plan.

A home that sorts has a habit. A street that sorts can ask for sorted collection.



1

IDENTIFY WEEKS 1–2

- Make a team of young people and community members. Give everyone a responsibility.
- Find waste collection points, and the recyclable materials common on your street.

2

SHOW WEEKS 3–4

- With permission, install bins in the three colours at the collection points.
- Hold a demonstration: sort a heap of mixed waste in public. Explain everyone's moral and legal duty to sort.

3

COORDINATE WEEKS 5–6

- Contact the local authority and waste collectors. Decide who keeps each area clean.
- Ask shopkeepers, schools and housing societies for support.
- Meet scrap dealers and recyclers. Ask about prices and collection.

4

ADVOCATE WEEKS 7–8

- Campaign for sorted collection, so sorted waste stays sorted in the truck.
- Ask the municipality, or its contractor, to own waste collection on your street.

Your result: do the 7-day challenge in week 1 and week 8. The difference is what your street changed.

What the law says.

Each province and region has its own law to protect the environment and control pollution and waste.

Islamabad

Pakistan Environmental Protection Act 1997; Single-Use Plastics Regulations 2023

COVERS Pollution, hazardous waste, polythene bags and other single-use plastic.

Up to **Rs 1 million**

Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

Punjab

Punjab Environmental Protection Act 1997, amended 2012

COVERS Pollution, hazardous waste.

Up to **Rs 5 million**

Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

Sindh

Sindh Environmental Protection Act 2014

COVERS Pollution, dumping waste in unauthorised places, non-degradable plastic.

Up to **Rs 5 million**

Repeat offence: up to 3 years in prison

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

KP Environmental Protection Act 2014; Amendment Act 2022

COVERS Pollution, hazardous waste, plastic bags.

Rs 50,000 to Rs 5 million

Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

Balochistan

Balochistan Environmental Protection Act 2012

COVERS Pollution; hazardous, electronic, solid and hospital waste.

Up to **Rs 1 million**

Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

Gilgit-Baltistan

Gilgit-Baltistan Environmental Protection Act 2014

COVERS Pollution, hazardous waste.

Up to **Rs 1 million**

Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

Azad Jammu and Kashmir

AJK Environmental Protection Act 2000

COVERS Pollution, hazardous waste, used polythene bags.

Up to **Rs 1 million**

Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

At home, the rule is simple: don't burn waste, don't dump it in drains or empty plots, and keep special waste apart.

MY PLEDGE

Starting today, I will

WASTE CHAMPION

- [ ] Carry my own bag and bottle
- [ ] Say no to plastic I don't need
- [ ] Sort my waste three ways
- [ ] Sell or compost what I can
- [ ] Never burn rubbish
- [ ] Teach one person what I learned

NAME _____ DATE _____

AT HOME, ASK

"What can I change?"

ON YOUR STREET, ASK

"Who is responsible for collecting our waste?"

VSO Volunteers spark others